

Session 1
Start of the Lesson (10 minutes)
Answer the prompts below individually, then discuss your responses with your group. Be ready to share one insight during class. 1. What feature or function of your prototype best represents your team's creativity or problem-solving ability? The personalized supplement recommendation feature best represents our team's creativity and problem-solving ability because it uses Artificial Intelligence to analyze user information and provide suitable supplement suggestions based on health conditions, age, and dietary preferences
2. What evidence or reasoning most strongly supports your choice of tools or technologies? The MERN Stack was selected because it provides fast development, scalability, efficient database management, and responsive web application performance.
3. What was one key improvement or lesson you learned from user testing that strengthened your project? the importance of improving recommendation accuracy and mobile responsiveness to provide a better user experience.
4. Which Design Thinking principle do you think your team applied most effectively throughout the Capstone process so far? (Empathize, Define, Ideate, Prototype, or Test) the Test principle most effectively because we continuously gathered user feedback, identified system issues, and improved the prototype based on testing results.

Try It Out: What Makes a Pitch Stick?

1. Think about the best presentation or video you've seen recently. What made it memorable?

The presentation became memorable because it used simple explanations, clear visuals, relatable examples, and storytelling that connected with the audience.

2. What's the difference between explaining a project and telling a story about a project?

Explaining a project focuses on technical details and features, while telling a story focuses on real-life problems, user experiences, and the impact of the solution.

3. Why do you think good visuals and storytelling are essential when presenting to non-technical audiences (like clients or panelists)?

Good visuals and storytelling help non-technical audiences understand the project more easily by simplifying complex ideas and showing the real-life value and benefits of the system.

Part 1: Storyboarding the Pitch Narrative

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Objective: Outline the flow of your pitch deck before creating slides.

Instructions:

1. Work in your Capstone groups.
2. Use the Pitch Storyboard Template to plan 6–7 slides.
3. Include all seven pitch elements listed above.
4. Assign group roles
 - Note-taker - record ideas
 - Presenter(s) - leads storytelling
 - Designer - creates slides or visuals

Blank Storyboard Template

Slide	Content	Notes (Storytelling cues)
1	Hook/Opening Story	"Meet Mark, an active gym-goer trying to fix his poor sleep. He spent thousands on random supplements he found online, only to end up with constant stomach aches because they conflicted with his current allergy medications."
2	Problem Statement	"The supplement industry is a wild west. Millions of people guess what vitamins to take based on social media trends, completely unaware of dangerous ingredient interactions or incorrect dosages."
3	Solution (Prototype)	"Introducing SuppliWise: A MERN-stack web app that uses Groq AI (Llama 3.3 70B) to deliver custom, safer health plans based on a detailed 4-step assessment covering symptoms, lifestyle, and medications."
4	Evidence (Research + Module 8 Testing)	"During our Alpha testing phase, 100% of internal test runs successfully processed multi-step assessment forms, delivering rapid 1-3 second AI recommendations and instant safety logs."
5	Improvements (Revision Plan)	"Based on test feedback, we drastically refined our backend prompt engineering, tightened our JSON parsing rules, and fortified our rule-based clinical fallback engine to maximize accuracy."
6	Impact/Value	"SuppliWise eliminates dangerous health guesswork. Users save money and protect their bodies by getting highly accurate dietary suggestions, lifestyle warnings, and a floating AI chat assistant for 24/7 wellness support."
7	Call-to-Action	"Empower smarter, safer everyday wellness. We invite panels, mentors, and health innovators to help us validate, test, and expand SuppliWise to maximize user health safety."

Session 2

Start of the Lesson (10 minutes)

Answer the following prompts individually, then share your thoughts with your group. Be ready to share one key insight during class discussion.

1. What was the strongest part of your team's pitch deck or storyboard from last session? Why do you think it worked well?

The Hook and Problem Statement. It worked well because talking about a real user getting stomach pains from dangerous, unvalidated supplement combinations instantly grabs attention and highlights a real safety issue.

2. What feedback did your group receive on your pitch content or visuals, and how did you respond to it?

We were told our pitch lacked concrete proof that the application actually works. We responded by adding clear data metrics from our alpha testing to show exactly how stable our AI recommendation engine is.

3. In your own words, what's the difference between a technical pitch and a non-technical pitch, and why is it important to master both?

A technical pitch focuses on the architecture (MERN stack, Groq API, JWT, and fallbacks), while a non-technical pitch focuses on user value, safety, and problem-solving. Mastering both allows us to impress code developers and satisfy non-technical project evaluators at the same time.

4. Which storytelling element (hook, problem, solution, evidence, impact, or call-to-action) do you think still needs the most improvement in your team's presentation — and how will you refine it today?

The Evidence section. We will refine it today by adding more clear, explicit data metrics from our alpha testing results to prove exactly how fast and reliable our 4-step health wizard and local chatbot fallback logic perform under stress.

Try It Out: What Makes Feedback Helpful?

1. What kind of feedback helps you improve your presentation most — compliments, suggestions, or questions?

Suggestions and target questions, because they pinpoint specific bugs in our presentation flow or weak spots in our system architecture that we missed.

2. How can you give feedback that is specific, respectful, and useful?

By pointing out a specific issue (e.g., "The font on the warnings slide is too small to read") and offering a clear, constructive way to fix it without insulting the creator.

3. Why do you think practicing your pitch in front of peers is important before your final Capstone presentation?

It helps us spot confusing technical talk, catch pacing issues, and iron out bugs in our system demo so we stay sharp and confident in front of the actual evaluation panel.

Think Back and Think About (10 minutes)

Think Back: What did you learn or practice today that helped you **communicate your project's story more clearly and confidently**? What specific strategies, visuals, or feedback improved your understanding?

Using a 7-part story helped us explain SuppliWise from a user's perspective instead of just listing code. Starting with a real-life example made it easy to explain our 4-step wizard and AI features clearly.

Think About: How does learning to **present your project persuasively** connect to skills you'll need in **real-life IT work** or future career situations (e.g., client meetings, demos, reports)?

Being persuasive prepares us for real IT work like client demos, project proposals, and team reports. In a tech career, you have to explain the actual value and safety benefits of your software to people who do not understand code.